AI Policy Fellowship 2026

The IAPS AI Policy Fellowship is a fully-funded, three-month program for professionals from varied backgrounds seeking to strengthen practical policy skills for **securing a positive future in a world with powerful AI.**

Applications are now closed. To get notified when applications for our next cohort opens, sign up to our newsletter.

Fellowship Overview

Dates and Location

June 1st to Aug 21st
D.C. or remote

Applicants may choose to do the Fellowship fully in-person in D.C. or remotely.

All fellows will come together for a required in-person residency in D.C. on June 1-12.

Financial Support

Senior Fellows will receive **$22,000** and Fellows will receive **$15,000** as a stipend to work full-time during the 3-month program.

We can provide part-time options for exceptional candidates.

We can provide financial support for travel and accommodation for the two-week D.C. residency.

Day-to-day

Fellows work independently on projects such as writing policy memos and reports, briefing government officials, and organizing ambitious convenings.

They have weekly meetings with their mentor and an IAPS manager, and present their work in the final week.

Who Should Apply

We welcome applicants with policy and technical backgrounds (e.g., industry, government, think tanks) at various seniority levels. Fellows range from those in the middle of their undergraduate studies to those with decades of experience. The common thread is a solid understanding of their subject matter, the AI policy priorities IAPS focuses on, or both.

About IAPS

The Institute for AI Policy and Strategy (IAPS) is a nonpartisan think tank that produces policy research to address the implications of AI, from today's most advanced models to potential AGI and superintelligence. Our work equips policymakers and industry leaders to protect innovation while navigating high-magnitude risks and opportunities at the intersection of AI, national security, and geopolitics.

About the Fellowship

Fellows join IAPS to conduct an independent AI policy project, with mentorship from a leading expert in the field. Each fellow is paired with a mentor, either from the IAPS team or from within in our network.

Tackle real-world AI policy challenges

Fellows will begin with a two week, in-person residency in D.C. for the start of the Fellowship, from June 1-12th. During the kickoff residency, they will explore the AI policy landscape and get the opportunity to meet other fellows, IAPS researchers, and a variety of AI policy experts.

Afterwards, they will spend the remaining 10 weeks working with an AI policy expert, who will mentor them on projects that will influence national and global AI policies. Key policy fields include national security implications of AI, government acquisition and procurement of AI, CBRN capabilities of AI models, export controls, evaluations, geopolitics of AI, hardware-enabled mechanisms, jurisdictionally-focused policy questions (e.g., U.S., U.K., and E.U.), among several others.

Fellows' projects can have a variety of formats depending on each expert and fellowship coordinator, and will be set in partnership with each fellow. Examples of projects that fellows have worked on include:

- Authoring policy briefs or memos
- Giving briefings or presentations to government officials
- Writing or contributing to a research report
- Organizing a 200-attendee international conference
- Publishing an op-ed about a salient or neglected AI policy issue
- Providing strategic advice to a think tank expanding their operations to a new jurisdiction
- Helping streamline the operations of a newly-created AI policy organization
- Shaping the strategy for and helping run a track II event

These concrete outputs help strengthen fellows' AI policy track record while achieving impactful outcomes.

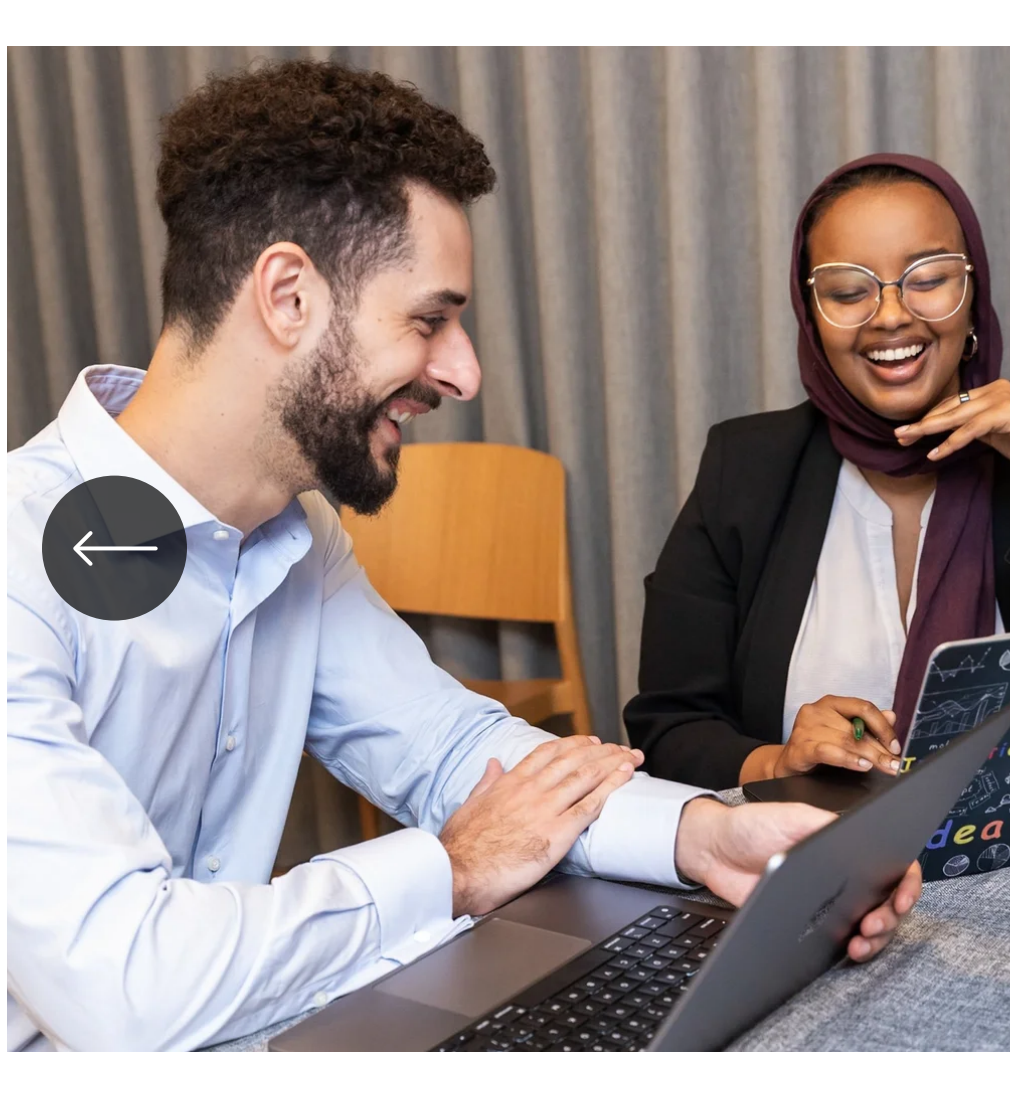
Preparing you for after the Fellowship

The Fellowship is designed to support a smooth transition into an AI policy career. Whether you're aiming to work in government, a think tank, or industry, the program equips you with the skills, knowledge, and connections needed to succeed.

In addition to working closely with a leading expert in the field, fellows receive:

- **Weekly one-on-one coaching** from an IAPS Fellowship Coordinator focused on career development, project management, and productivity;
- **Ongoing support** from IAPS researchers and policy staff, including direct feedback on their projects, such as via weekly work-in-progress sessions;
- **Access to our professional network**, including many networking opportunities during our two-week kickoff in DC; and
- **Additional financial assistance**, in select cases, to support career transitions after the program.

The program is well suited for both those with policy experience looking to transition into AI, or those with AI expertise looking to build more policy experience. Alumni of the Fellowship have gone on to full-time roles in industry, government, and at top think tanks like RAND, the Institute for Progress, the Center for Health Security and IAPS itself.



Join our community in Washington, D.C.

All fellows will begin the program with a two-week in-person residency in Washington, D.C. (June 1–12), where they will connect with the full IAPS team and partner experts. During this time, fellows will meet with their expert supervisor, participate in trainings on AI systems and policy challenges, workshop their Fellowship projects, and take part in a range of events—including roundtables, policy briefings, and informal networking gatherings.

For fellows based in D.C. throughout the program, IAPS will offer office space and regular in-person events to support ongoing collaboration and engagement.

Join remotely from around the world

IAPS welcomes remote fellows from many countries and provides multiple ways to stay connected and engaged. Every fellow (D.C. or remote) receives a support budget that can be used for in-person opportunities, such as attending conferences or meeting with their assigned expert.

As a remote-first organization, IAPS has the systems and experience to fully support remote participation and are able to legally hire in many countries. However, due to administrative or legal constraints, there may be some exceptions. These vary by individual circumstance, and we'll follow up directly if there are any limitations based on your location. If you have questions about a specific country, feel free to contact us at fellowship@iaps.ai.

Featured fellows from our 2024 and 2025 cohorts

Andrea Sawka Fiegl

THE FUTURE SOCIETY AND COMMON CAUSE

Andrea partnered with The Future Society's U.S. AI Governance Team to develop evidence-based policy frameworks necessary for ensuring that AI systems are safe and adhere to fundamental human values. She brings 15+ years of experience at USAID and on the Senate Foreign Relations Committee.

She now works at Common Cause on emerging technologies and democratic resilience.

Dave Banerjee

IAPS

Dave wrote a report on AI integrity--ensuring that AI systems are not tampered with, backdoored, or have secret loyalties--during the Fellowship. His research interests include securing frontier AI systems and preventing AI-driven power centralization.

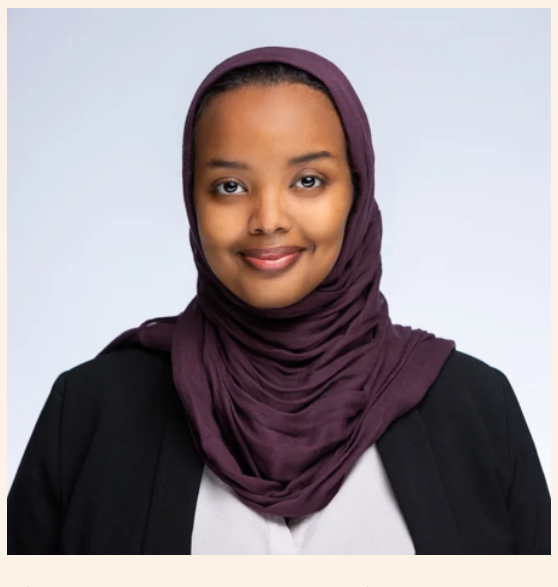
Dave Banerjee is now a research associate at IAPS and a research manager at ERA.

Tao Burga

INSTITUTE FOR PROGRESS

Tao worked with the Institute for Progress (IFP) and the Center for a New American Security (CNAS) on translating compute policy proposals for government and industry audiences.

He is now a full-time Technology Fellow at IFP.



Sumaya Nur Adan

UNIVERSITY OF OXFORD

Sumaya wrote a commentary piece on the international network of AI Safety Institutes with IAPS.

She later went on to co-found the Center for AI Security and Access, and pursue a DPhil in Computer Science at the University of Oxford.

Selected Mentors

Oliver Guest

INTERNATIONAL STRATEGY

Oliver is the Research Manager leading the International Strategy team at IAPS. His work particularly focuses on geopolitical dynamics around the governance of advanced AI, as well as the AI landscape in China.

He has an MA in Security Studies from Germany's Institute for Peace Research and Security Policy, where he specialized in emerging technologies and graduated at the top of the cohort. Oliver is also an affiliate of the Safe AI Forum.

Melissa Hopkins

AIxBIO

Melissa is the Senior Policy Advisor at the Johns Hopkins Center for Health Security, where she works to bridge the gap between academics and policymakers. Melissa led the development of the Gene Synthesis Screening Information Hub and is a PI on the Center's AIxBio project.

Melissa brings years of experience working on and around Capitol Hill, most recently serving as Legislative Fellow to Representative Anna G. Eshoo in the US House of Representatives, specializing in technology issues, including risks posed by biotechnology. Previously, Melissa served as Law Clerk for the House Oversight Committee and as an intern for Representative Kweisi Mfume. Melissa graduated from The George Washington University Law School.

Cara Labrador

FRONTIER SECURITY

Cara is a Senior Researcher on the Frontier Security team at IAPS with a background in the intersection of technology and national security.

Prior to IAPS, Cara worked in the Global Technology Practice at a national security advisory firm based in Washington, D.C. Cara previously served as an Editorial Associate at the Council on Foreign Relations. She holds a Master in Public Affairs from Princeton University's School of Public and International Affairs and a Bachelor of Arts in Government and Classical Studies from Dartmouth College.

Frequently Asked Questions

Do I need to have a technical background or a deep technical understanding of AI systems? +

Do I need policy experience to apply? +

What are you looking for in successful candidates? +

What does the selection process look like? +

What are IAPS's motivations and goals for the program? +

How many fellows are you planning to select? +

What will I work on during the Fellowship? +

How will I get matched with my mentor? +

Can I do the program part-time? +

Who is eligible to apply to the D.C. option? +

Who is eligible for the remote option? –

As a remote-first organization, IAPS has the systems and experience to fully support remote participation and are able to legally hire in many countries. However, due to administrative or legal constraints, there may be some exceptions. These vary by individual circumstance, and we'll follow up directly if there are any limitations based on your location. If you have questions about a specific country, feel free to contact us at fellowship@iaps.ai.

If I am eligible to apply to both the D.C. and remote options, can I apply to both? +

Will I receive additional funding to relocate to D.C.? +

How will candidates be selected between Senior Fellow and Fellow roles? +

Is there a difference in terms of programming for Senior Fellows and Fellows? +

Is there flexibility on the start or end dates? +

What are fellows' salaries and benefits? When do I receive the stipend? +

How do I obtain a visa as a remote Fellow for the two-week residency in Washington, D.C.? / Can you help me obtain a visa? +

Curious about IAPS's work?

Advanced AI systems pose both immense opportunities and complex challenges. IAPS addresses these with practical policy solutions at the intersection of AI policy and national security through in-depth policy research.

Read our research

Curious about our past fellows?

Our fellows have secured positions in government, industry, leading think tanks, and academia, founded new projects and organizations, and been recognized on lists of the best AI policy researchers.

Read about our 2025 fellows

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